

Meeting Notes — Tokuo Aomi (青海 徳生) · Sugano Organic

Meeting: After the Tokyo meeting (July 1, 2026) — exact date TBD, in Mitsue

About Tokuo

- Owner of **Sugano Organic** — natural clothing and nature sounds, deep connection to nature and sustainability
- Lives in Mitsue Village
- Owns **28.05 hectares of Sugi forest** on his mountain
- Shared framed calligraphy of 日常の五心 — Rob saw this and felt an immediate kinship

日常の五心 — The Five Hearts of Daily Life

A classic Japanese moral teaching, often displayed in schools and homes:

1. ハイという 素直の心 — The honest heart that says "Yes"
2. すみませんという 反省の心 — The reflective heart that says "I'm sorry"
3. わたしがしますという 奉仕の心 — The serving heart that says "Let me do it"
4. おかげさまでという 合掌の心 — The grateful heart that says "Thanks to you" (hands together)
5. ありがとうという 感謝の心 — The thankful heart that says "Thank you"

Core Idea: Sugano Organic — Powered by Nature

Slogan: *Sugano Organic — Powered by Nature*

Make Sugano Organic completely powered and heated by nature — using the Sugi trees on Tokuo's own mountain. Nothing from distant power plants, nothing artificial.

Tokuo becomes the first living prototype of the Mitsue biomass concept. Others can follow.

Biomass CHP System — 10 kW (recommended size)

Electrical output

Item	Value
Electrical output	10 kW
Required thermal input	45.5 kW
Wood consumption	10.9 kg/hour · 87 kg/day · 21.8 tonnes/year
Annual electricity	20,000 kWh/year
Grid saving	¥540,000/year
CO ₂ avoided	9.0 tonnes/year

Tokuo's own forest (28.05 ha)

Item	Value
Annual harvest (30-yr rotation)	0.94 ha/year → 5.6 tonnes/year
Initial thinning (35% of overgrown stock)	~196 tonnes — ~9 years of fuel
Total forest needed (long-term)	~109 ha → supplement ~5 t/yr from village forest

Key insight: His overgrown Sugi forest needs thinning anyway. The initial clearance alone fuels the first 9 years. Long-term, a small top-up from Mitsue community forest covers the gap — strengthening the community angle.

Mitsue Kanko could help arrange the wood cutting and processing.

+ CHP Heat Recovery (recommended add-on)

Item	Value
Recoverable waste heat	28.4 kW
House + factory heating need	~23 kW ✓ (enough)
Heating saving vs kerosene	¥340,000/year
Overall system efficiency	84% (vs 22% electricity only)
Extra investment for heat recovery	¥1.5M – ¥3.5M

Full system costs

Item	Low	High
Generator + installation	¥3,500,000	¥6,875,000
CHP heat recovery add-on	¥1,500,000	¥3,500,000
Total	¥5,000,000	¥10,375,000
Combined annual saving	¥880,000/year	—
Payback	5 years	11 years

Subsidies (METI, NEDO, Ministry of Agriculture rural biomass programs) could cover 50–70% of investment. The NGO is the financial tunnel.

Email sent to Tokuo (2026-06-23)

English

Subject: Sugano Organic — Powered by Nature

Dear Tokuo-san,

When I saw the 日常の五心, I felt we share the same spirit.

I have an idea that could make Sugano Organic completely powered and heated by nature — using the Sugi trees on your own mountain. Nothing from distant power plants, nothing artificial.

I would love to see your place become the first living proof of this in Mitsue — a prototype that others can follow. Mitsue Kanko could help with the wood cutting and processing, and the NGO I am setting up could arrange the logistics and funding.

I would love to share the details with you soon.

With warm regards, Rob

Japanese

件名 : Sugano Organic — 自然の力で動く

青海徳生さんへ

「日常の五心」を拝見したとき、私たちは同じ心を持っていると感じました。

あなたの山にある杉の木を使って、Sugano Organicの電力と暖房をすべて自然の力でまかなうアイデアがあります。遠くの発電所も、人工的なものも、何も必要ありません。

あなたの場所を、御杖での最初の「生きた証明」にしたいのです。他の人たちが続けるための原型として。御杖観光が木の伐採と加工を担い、私が設立するNGOが物流と資金調達を手配できると思っています。

近いうちに詳しいお話ができることを楽しみにしています。

敬具 ロブ

Instagram message sent: 青海さん、先ほどメールをお送りしました。ぜひご覧ください！😊

Connection to Core Project Concept

This collaboration embodies the master slogan:

"The forest our ancestors planted — the power that sustains the village they built." 先人が植えた森が、今、村を支える力になる。

The generations who planted and tended Tokuo's Sugi forest never imagined it would one day power a home and workshop. Their patient work is now bearing fruit.